



Men on a mission: Much would rest on Shubman Gill (centre), K.L. Rahul (left) and Yashasvi Jaiswal (right) to keep the batting fires burning for India. PTI

A NEW CHAPTER ACROSS THE PALK STRAIT

Fresh faces and familiar challenges await in Sri Lanka, as Shubman Gill & Co. look to establish a **new identity** in Test cricket.



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A journey to Sri Lanka, often a highpoint in a global tourist's life, now beckons the Indian Test squad. In an island known as Serendip in the distant past, and one that birthed the word serendipity, Shubman Gill's men are searching for their share of happy accidents that would land them success in the white shade.

Stretching from August 15-27 in a tour that is short but bound to have a long-standing impact, the two Tests in Galle and Colombo would reveal the progress that India has made while coping with

transition. **After a slew of retirements, India's batting core has moved on from Virat Kohli, Rohit Sharma, Cheteshwar Pujara and Ajinkya Rahane.**

The bowling will miss ace spinner R. Ashwin while Jasprit Bumrah's injury means Mohammed Siraj and company will have to step up on the